

Generated from the competition table

1978 FIFA World Cup

Everything the FIFA World Cup edition table records about 1978, with each placing linked to that team's full history.

Host(s)

Argentina

Teams

16

Winner

Argentina

Runner-up

Netherlands

Third

Brazil

Fourth / other semifinalist

Italy

Final

**Argentina 3-1
Netherlands (a.e.t.)**

Final date

25 June 1978

Top scorer

**Mario Kempes
(Argentina, 6 goals)**

All FIFA World Cup editions →



References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 30 August 2026

- **FIFA tournament history and champions** (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1930-1978-uruguay-italy-germany-brazil-england-argentina>).

- FIFA tournament history and champions (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1982-2026-italy-argentina-germany-brazil-france-spain>).
- FIFA 2026 awards (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/award-winners>).
- FIFA historical top scorers (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/fontaine-mbappe-ronaldo-and-more-every-world-cup-top-scorer>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/unai-simon-adidas-golden-glove>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (https://www.espn.com/soccer/story/_/id/49024760/2026-world-cup-awards-golden-ball-golden-boot-golden-glove-trophies-revealed).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.si.com/soccer/every-world-cup-golden-glove-winner>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.goal.com/en/news/list-of-fifa-world-cup-golden-glove-winners/blt81d4e6d207efc5ff>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.nzherald.co.nz/sport/football/football-world-cup/soccer-germanys-kahn-named-best-goalskeeper-at-cup/TK3UHH6DI4DUUQFZEXZRTYUKR4/>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.plus.fifa.com/en/content/oliver-kahn-lev-yashin-award-2002-fifa-world-cup-korea-japan/235d069a-542f-4d26-8b91-f3ab2dc42649>).
- Golden Glove (best goalkeeper) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a (<https://www.goal.com/en/news/world-cup-2010-spains-iker-casillas-wins-golden-glove-ahead/bltf926cf07eb87996a>).
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1930_FIFA_World_Cup_final).
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1966_FIFA_World_Cup_final).
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2022_FIFA_World_Cup_final).
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2026_FIFA_World_Cup_final).
- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1934_FIFA_World_Cup_final).
- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1994_FIFA_World_Cup_final).
- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/final>).

- Third/fourth-place audit (2026-08-04): the winner and loser of every (<https://www.espn.com/soccer/>).
- Third/fourth-place audit (2026-08-04): the winner and loser of every (<https://plus.fifa.com/>)
- Third/fourth-place audit (2026-08-04): the winner and loser of every (<https://www.athlet.org/>).
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicou sa2026/articles/spain-argentina-final-report-highlights>).
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/760517/argentina-spai n).
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.cbsnews.com/news/2026-fifa-world-cup-final-spain-argen tina-sunday/>).
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicou sa2026/articles/france-england-report-highlights-bronze-final>).
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/760516/england-franc e).
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (<https://www.foxnews.com/sports/england-wins-thriller-ages-france-cla im-third-2026-fifa-world-cup>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/w orld-cup-champions-1930-1978-uruguay-italy-germany-brazil-england-argentina>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/w orld-cup-champions-1982-2026-italy-argentina-germany-brazil-france-spain>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (<https://www.espn.com/soccer/>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1934_FIFA_World_Cup_final).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (<https://www.bbc.com/sport/football>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score audit (2026-08-05, intensive run): the core (<https://www.cnn.com/sport/football>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.rsssf.org/tables/30f.html>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.britannica.com/event/World-Cup-2010>).

- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.worldfootball.net/report/wm-1970-in-mexiko-ends-piel-brasilien-italien/>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (https://www.transfermarkt.us/germany_argentina/index/spielbericht/2466308).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.11v11.com/matches/brazil-v-italy-17-july-1994-245173/>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.skysports.com/football/news/12098/11437927>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.thefa.com/news/2014/jul/29/england-west-germany-world-cup-final-1966-4-2>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.cbssports.com/soccer/news/>).
- Champion/Runner-up/Final-score second-source audit (2026-08-07, intensive (<https://www.espn.com/soccer/>).
- Host(s)/Teams audit (2026-08-08, intensive run): the first-ever (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/FIFA_World_Cup)
- Host(s)/Teams audit (2026-08-08, intensive run): the first-ever (<https://www.rsssf.org/>).
- Host(s)/Teams audit (2026-08-08, intensive run): the first-ever (<https://www.footballhistory.org/>).
- Host(s)/Teams audit (2026-08-08, intensive run): the first-ever (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026>)
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.worldfootball.net/competition/co139/fifa-world-cup/se2413/1966-england/all-matches/>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.worldfootball.net/competition/co139/fifa-world-cup/se2414/1970-mexico/teams/>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.worldfootball.net/competition/co139/fifa-world-cup/se2418/1986-mexico/teams/>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.britannica.com/today-in-history/July-13-1930-First-FIFA-World-Cup>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.britannica.com/event/2026-FIFA-World-Cup>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (https://liquipedia.net/lab/Football/FIFA/World_Cup/1958).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (https://liquipedia.net/lab/Football/FIFA/World_Cup/1974).

- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.transfermarkt.us/mundial-de-qatar-2022/teilnehmer/pokalwettbewerb/wm22/sort/teilnahmen>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (https://grokipedia.com/page/1938_FIFA_World_Cup).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/number-teams-every-edition>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/why-2026-world-cup-spread-133500991.html>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.mlssoccer.com/news/fifa-world-cup-2026-format-explained>).
- Host(s)/Teams second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive (<https://www.skysports.com/football/news/11095/13272067/2026-world-cup-dates-venues-host-cities-format-and-schedule-for-usa-canada-and-mexico-tournament>).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (<https://www.nbcbayarea.com/world-cup/every-third-place-game-result-in-fifa-world-cup-history/3102549/>).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (<https://sports.yahoo.com/every-third-place-game-result-110022284.html>).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (<https://www.soccergraph.com/2026/07/fifa-world-cup-third-place-playoff-winners-bronze-medalists-history.html>).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (<https://www.rsssf.org/tables/30full.html>).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (https://www.sport-histoire.fr/en/Sport/Football/World_Cup/1950_World_Cup.php).
- Third/fourth-place second independent cross-check (2026-08-11, intensive (<https://www.aljazeera.com/sports/liveblog/2026/7/18/france-vs-england-live-fifa-world-cup-2026-third-place-playoff>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.